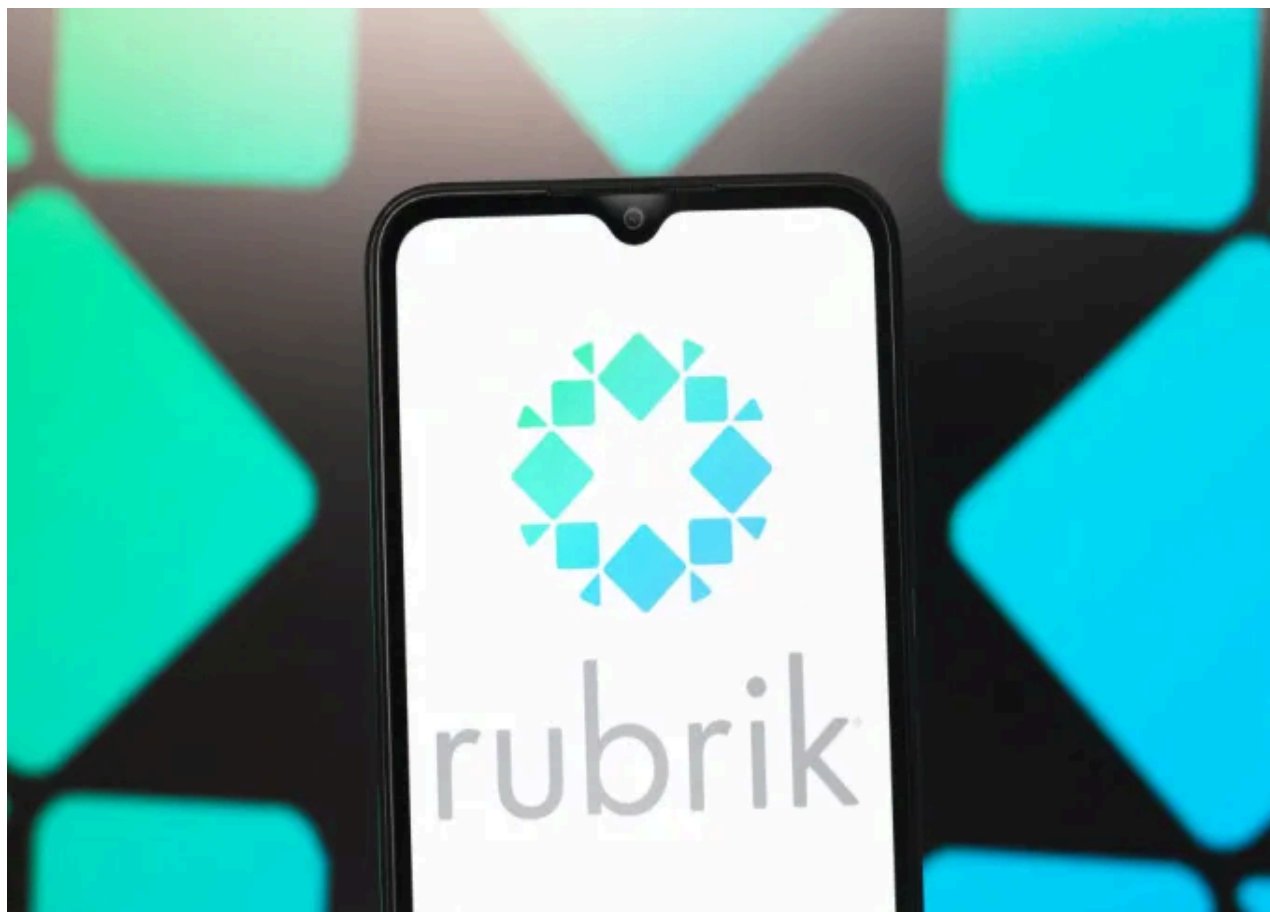


# Startups Weekly: Tech and the law

Welcome to *Startups Weekly* — your weekly recap of everything you can't miss from the world of startups. Want it in your inbox every Friday? [Sign up here](#).

Before this newsletter takes a break for the Fourth of July next week, here are the startup stories and funding rounds that caught our eye over the last few days, which have been quite busy.

## Most interesting startup stories from the week



**Image Credits:** SOPA Images / Contributor / Getty Images

This week brought us lawsuit updates, M&As, and a combination of both.

**AI agents:** Data cybersecurity company Rubrik [acquired Predibase](#) to accelerate the adoption of AI agents by its users. The startup, which helps companies fine-tune AI models, had raised some \$28 million in venture capital. Deal amount wasn't disclosed but was reportedly sizable.

**Sailing:** German startup Kadmos, which had raised \$38 million in external capital for its salary payment platform for seafaring workers, [got acquired by NYK Line](#) as part of the Japanese shipping firm's efforts to expand its fintech services.

**Red herring?** Embattled AI music startup Suno [announced the acquisition of WavTool](#), a browser-based AI digital audio workstation, in a deal that actually happened a few months ago but that it chose to disclose on the heels of yet another copyright lawsuit.

**Unstable ground:** Getty Images [dropped its primary lawsuit against Stability AI](#), the startup behind AI image generator Stable Diffusion, but other lawsuits continue, both in the U.S. and in the U.K.

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**Weathering the storm:** Despite headwinds, Bill Gates-backed startup Airloom Energy is pressing on and [started building its first wind power plant](#) in Wyoming.

## Most interesting VC and funding news this week



Kalshi CEO Tarek Mansour at StrictlyVC 2025. **Image Credits:** TechCrunch

Another week, another \$300 million round — sometimes at wildly different valuations, even for the same company. Meanwhile, the small deals keep things interesting, too.

**Same amount, new valuation:** Harvey AI raised [a \\$300 million Series E](#) co-led by Kleiner Perkins and Coatue. This comes only four months after Sequoia led a \$300 million Series D at a \$3 billion valuation into the AI-enabled legal tech startup, which is now valued at \$5 billion.

**AI scribe:** Abridge, an AI startup automating medical notes, [secured a \\$300 million Series E](#) led by a16z at a \$5.3 billion valuation.

**Crypto predictions:** Blockchain-based prediction market platform Kalshi [raised a \\$185 million round at a \\$2 billion post-money valuation](#), while rival Polymarket is reportedly working on closing a \$200 million round at a pre-money valuation around \$1 billion.

**Money in the bank:** Finom, a challenger bank that targets SMBs across Europe, [raised some \\$133 million in a Series C round of funding](#) that comes in addition to the \$105 million in growth funding it secured from General Catalyst's Customer Value Fund a few weeks ago.

**Flying high:** Indian drone startup Raphe mPhibr [raised \\$100 million in an all-equity Series B round](#) led by General Catalyst. Its customers include the Indian Army, Navy, and Air Force, as well as armed police forces.

**Easy dictation:** AI-powered dictation app Wispr Flow [locked in \\$30 million in a Series A](#) that brought its total funding to \$56 million. The company also [released an iOS app](#) earlier this month.

**Upcycled:** Novoloop, a startup that upcycles waste plastic, [raised a \\$21 million Series B](#) to finalize the design and begin the construction of its first commercial-scale plant.

**Data processing for AI:** Eventual, a startup inspired by a data-processing problem its founders encountered at Lyft, [raised two rounds of funding totaling \\$27.5 million](#) within eight months.

**AI voices:** Synthflow AI, a Berlin-based no-code platform that lets enterprises build and deploy customized white-label voice AI customer service agents, [raised a \\$20 million Series A](#) led by Accel.

**As the name suggests:** Better Auth, the third Ethiopian startup to graduate from YC, [raised \\$5 million in seed funding](#). Its open source framework promises to simplify how developers manage user authentication and has quickly become popular.

**Eternal light:** Space startup Lux Aeterna [came out of stealth](#) with \$4 million in pre-seed funding and the ambition to launch a reusable satellite in 2027.

## Last but not least



**Image Credits:**Dani Padgett / StrictlyVC

After a two-year break from public life, seasoned early-stage investor, entrepreneur, and author Brad Feld is back with his ninth book, “Give First.” TechCrunch [interviewed him about it and more](#).

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- [OpenAI reportedly 'recalibrating' compensation in response to Meta hires](#)
  - [Anthony Ha](#)
- [Meta reportedly hires four more researchers from OpenAI](#)
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- [Anthropic's Claude AI became a terrible business owner in experiment that got 'weird'](#)
  - [Julie Bort](#)
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